



## **Open Data, Design, & Development at the Office of Natural Resources Revenue**

# **Re-architecting contact information to meet user needs**

August 12, 2021

## **Identifying the problem**

One of the biggest user tasks for onrr.gov is finding contact information to answer questions. Industry users need to know who at the Office of Natural Resources Revenue (ONRR) can answer various types of questions. Today, the site includes 9 files with contact information, each organized differently.

Some are organized by company name or by the first letter of the company name and some by user task. The different organizations make it difficult to find the correct person to answer a given question. Users need an easier way to search and find the correct contact. ONRR's teams also need an easier way to update contacts. They currently send a new copy of the contact file (either a PDF or spreadsheet) each time a contact changes.



Office of Natural Resources Revenue  
U.S. Department of the Interior

Revenue Data

[Home](#) [Reporting/Paying](#) [Valuation](#) [Indian Services](#) [Compliance](#) [About](#)   

[Home](#) / [About](#) / [Contact Us](#)



## Contact Us

[Overview](#)  
[Leadership](#)  
[Office Locations](#)  
[Rules & Regulations](#)  
[Employment Opportunities](#)  
[Press Releases](#)  
[Natural Resources Revenue Data](#)  
[Committees & Coordination](#)  
[Freedom of Information Act](#)  
[Presentations & Testimony](#)  
[Anti-Harassment Program](#)  
[Interacting with ONRR](#)  
[Contact Us](#)

Search Table:

ONRR Contacts

| Topics                     | Contact                                                                                                       | Online Resources                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Making payments to ONRR    |  (800) 433-9801<br>Ext. 3668 | ONRR Contacts by Company Assignment: <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li><a href="#">Accounts Receivable, Billing, and Financial Issues Information -- Federal</a></li><li><a href="#">Accounts Receivable, Billing, and Financial Issues Information -- Indian</a></li><li><a href="#">Debt Collection - Company Assignments</a></li></ul> Additional Resources: <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li><a href="#">Payments</a></li><li><a href="#">Appeals &amp; Sureties</a></li><li><a href="#">Civil Penalties</a></li></ul> |
| Submitting reports to ONRR |  (800) 433-9801              | ONRR Contacts by Company Assignment: <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li><a href="#">Lease/Agreement Maintenance</a></li><li><a href="#">Offshore Production Reporting</a></li><li><a href="#">Onshore Production Reporting</a></li><li><a href="#">Royalty Reporting and Error Correction</a></li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |

User interviews showed that users found it difficult to sift through the current contact documents. Thus, I was tasked to come up with a design concept for contacts. I determined a search function would maximize the user’s ease of access and interactivity with the contact directory. Then I started to think about different ways to organize the contacts and create categories from patterns found. I decided to create a spreadsheet and some form of information architecture.

## Initial contact organization

First, I created a “stacked-box” information architecture within a document. Within each box I listed the categories that appeared in the original contact directory to see what fields there were. Then I viewed each category’s information structure, but I was not familiar with some terminology which made me ask questions. After I clarified those spots in our meeting, I moved onto creating new categories that the contacts could be organized by.

I then entered the categories and some contacts into a spreadsheet to see how the information could be divided within the directory. Next, I started organizing the entire contact directory onto the spreadsheet. As I was doing

this, I realized it would take me longer to complete and was thus inefficient. As a result, I decided to use the first contact listed as an example, then double checked to see if I was missing any areas.

## **Information architecture**

After I felt confident, I proceeded to create information architecture (IA) for the search function and the filter. Information Architecture is the practice of arranging the parts of something to be understandable.

The IA challenge for the search bar was to figure out how to display the search results, while the filter IA challenge was to determine what filter options should be present. To see if the current IA made sense, I created two user journeys detailing the actions to take in using the two functions, listed below.

## **User journeys**

### **Steps to find a contact**

Users had two information pathways to find contacts. They could use either the Search or Filter pathways to identify the person they were looking for.

### **Search Bar**

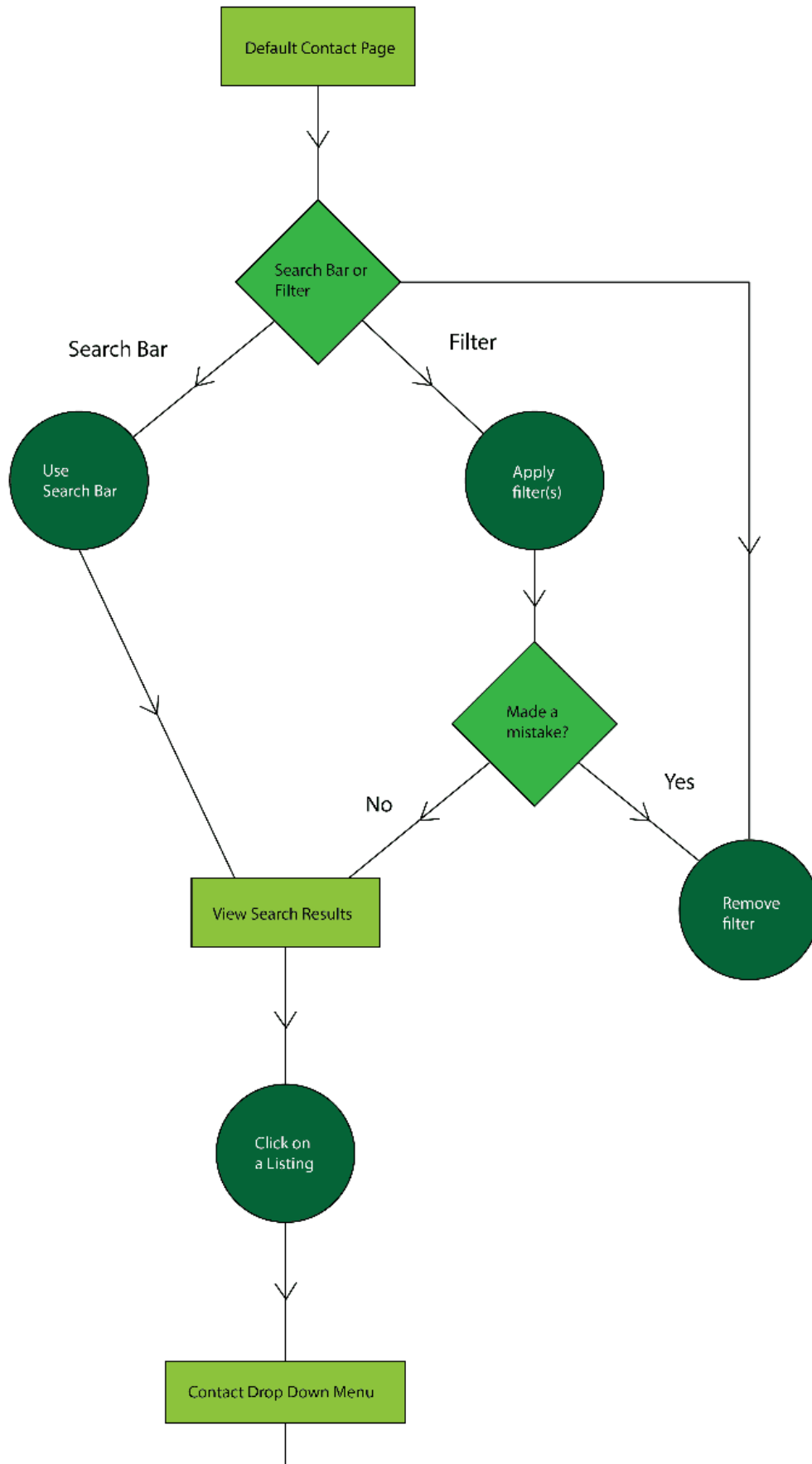
1. User types in contact name, company assignment, company name, etc.
2. Search Results will be presented in a list.
3. User clicks on a listing to expose a drop-down menu containing more information about that individual contact.
4. The user has the option to email or call that contact immediately via hyperlink.

## Filter

1. User applies up to 4 different filters at the same time. Each time they apply a filter a removable chip will appear below the search bar/header area.
2. Search Results will be presented in a list.
3. User clicks on a listing to expose drop-down menu containing more information about that individual contact.
4. The user has the option to email or call that contact immediately via hyperlink.

I combined the two user journeys into a single user flow of the possibilities the user could take when using the contact directory.

# Contacts User Flow





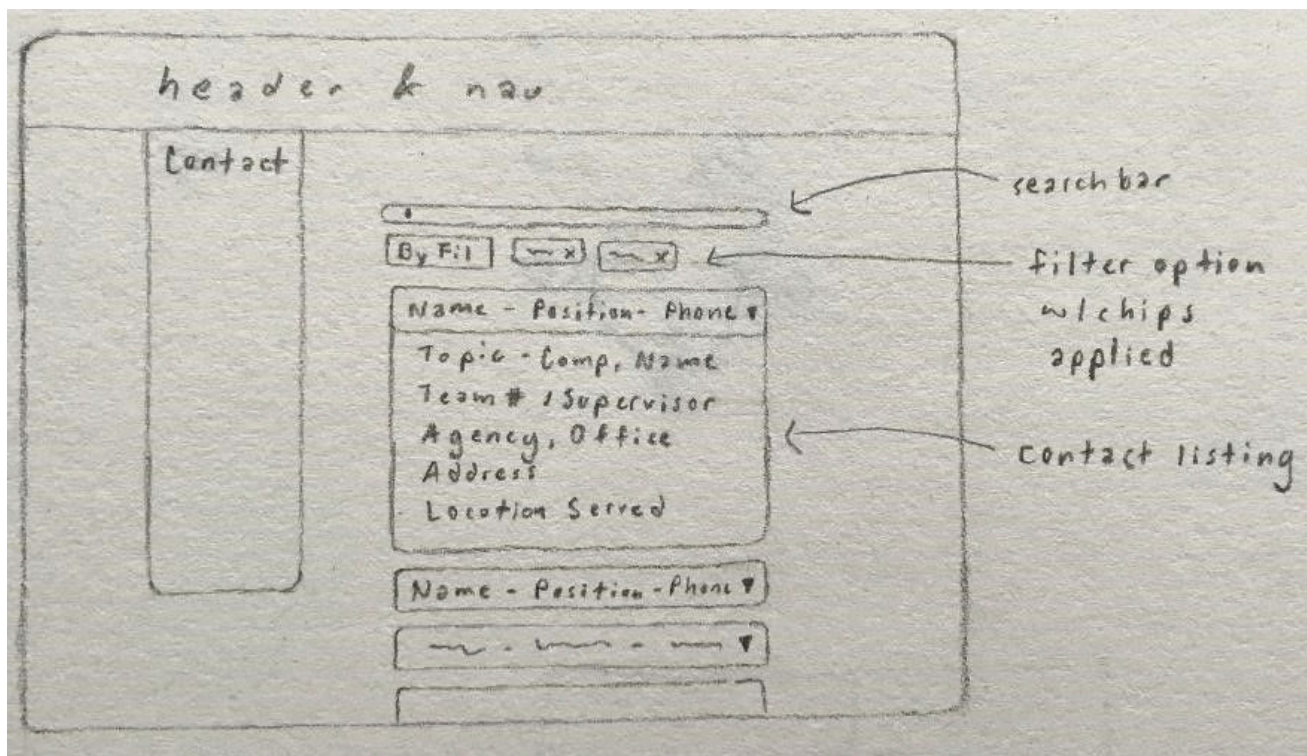
Based on user journeys, I decided on the below categories and sub-categories. These categories would become selectable filters for users.

- General
  - Contact Name
  - Company Assignment
  - Company Name
  - ONRR Office Locations
- Onshore/Offshore
  - Onshore
  - Offshore
  - Submitting Reports to ONRR
- Production/Revenue
  - Production
  - Revenue
- State and Local Government Disbursements from ONRR
- Federal/Indian
  - Federal
  - Indian

- Making Payments for ONRR
- Valuation Determination and Guidance
- Allottee of Individual Indian Mineral Owner Services
- Tribal Services
- Inquiries/Requests
  - Press or Media Inquiries
  - Congressional Inquiries
  - Data Requests
  - Technical Assistance
  - ONRR.gov Content Corrections/Comments
  - Freedom of Information Act (FOIA)

## **Design iterations**

After I decided how to organize the information through the IA, I used the old contact directory as a foundation for designing the user interface. I expanded the search bar to span the entire contact directory to prompt the user to interact with the table through the search function. I then created a filter option with chips next to the filter for when the user adds filters to their search. Next, I added the search results under the search bar and the filter, so the user can interact with each one to find out more information about the results.



After meeting with the team, I knew that I needed to differentiate between the categories and test out the design with a sample company. I decided I could start mocking up my sketches and presented them to everyone during our next meeting. The team suggested that I remove the legend because the filter options would save room and make the directory less cluttered.

When I presented my updated wireframe in the next meeting, my mentor, Shannon, and others were confused about whether the user had to use the search function first or not. From this feedback, I decided to make the prototype more dynamic and less linear to make the functionality clearer to the user. Additional feedback I received was regarding the drop-down filters, to group everything by category and create a filter for each with its own drop-down menu.

From the feedback, I went back and updated the IA bulleted list for the filters. Then I ran into the problem of how to categorize the main categories, which I brought up at the next intern meeting.

## **Revised filter categories**

At the intern meeting, I received feedback and restructured the filter categories.

- Search fields
  - Contact Name
  - Company Assignment
  - Company Name
  - ONRR Office Locations
- Land type
  - Onshore
  - Offshore
  - Indian
- Reporting & paying
  - Submitting Reports to ONRR
  - Production Reporting
  - Revenue Reporting
  - Making Payments to ONRR
  - Valuation Determination and Guidance
  - Allottee or Individual Indian Mineral Owner Services
  - Tribal Services
  - Technical Assistance
- Requests for information
  - Press or Media Inquiries

- Congressional Inquiries
- Data Requests
- ONRR.gov Content Corrections/Comments
- Freedom of Information Act (FOIA)
- State and Local Government Disbursements from ONRR

## **Final prototype design and next Steps**

After the meeting, where Shannon helped me to revise the categories, I updated the wireframe based on the new IA. As a result of my work on redesigning the contact directory, I received positive feedback from ONRR's leadership on its efficiency for the users. The next step is to pull in the existing contact information and get it into the prototype, so we can get stakeholder and user feedback. So far, the stakeholders who have reviewed it think it is much easier to find the correct contact. We plan on testing the design with users soon.

Header and Navigation

Contact Us

Search

Search Fields ▼

Land Type ▼

Reporting & Paying ▼

Requests for Information ▼

Name - Position - Phone - Email ▼

Name - Position - Phone - Email ▼

Name - Position - Phone - Email ▼

Name - Position - Phone - Email ▼

Name - Position - Phone - Email ▼

Name - Position - Phone - Email ▼

Name - Position - Phone - Email ▼

Name - Position - Phone - Email ▼

Name - Position - Phone - Email ▼

Name - Position - Phone - Email ▼

Working on the ONRR contact directory made me learn more about IA and usability through the IA bulleted list and creating the user journeys. These methods made me think critically about what information is and isn't essential for the user. This was especially true when it came to the structure and deciding the filter options by identifying common themes.

From here, I plan to investigate more information architecture techniques that I could use for future projects. Additionally, I plan to read more about usability to get a better sense of how well different features serve the user's needs in certain contexts.

*Note : Reference in this blog to any specific commercial product, process, or service, is for the information and convenience of the public, and does not constitute endorsement, recommendation, or favoring by the Department of the Interior.*



**Brandi Nichols:** User Experience Intern at the Office of Natural Resources Revenue.

[< A user-centered approach: simplicity and complexity in a homepage graphic](#)

[Document accessibility: getting from 5,000 to 0 >](#)

[Home](#)



## U.S. Department of the Interior

Office of Natural Resources Revenue  
PO Box 25165  
Denver, CO 80225-0165  
[nrrd@onrr.gov](mailto:nrrd@onrr.gov)

*From the team that works on Natural Resources Revenue Data and ONRR.gov. Have feedback or a blog post idea? Drop us a line.*

[About](#) [Accessibility](#) [Privacy Policy](#) [Freedom of Information Act \(FOIA\)](#)  
[Vulnerability Disclosure Policy](#) [No Fear Act](#)